

Project Brief

Driving more App Store page traffic for Cadence via Apple Search Ads

Prepared July 18, 2026 · Owner: Christian Kasper · Based on the Cadence ASA Playbook and Apple Ads Knowledge Base

1. Objective

Increase the number of people who land on Cadence's App Store page — and, downstream, the number who install and subscribe — by running a structured Apple Search Ads program. Apple Search Ads is the right first channel because Cadence has zero reviews today and no organic ranking history: paid placement inside App Store search is currently the only reliable way to put the app in front of people who are already looking for exactly what it does.

2. Background

App	Cadence · Interval Timer Flow — id6778636283
Category	Health & Fitness
What it does	Multi-block timer spanning interval training, breathwork, meditation, and focused work
Pricing	Free with IAP — Cadence Pro \$3.99/mo, \$19.99/yr, \$59.99 lifetime
Current reviews	None yet — effectively pre-launch from an App Store credibility standpoint
Positioning	Privacy-first: no accounts, no tracking, no ads, data stays on-device

Cadence isn't a single-purpose timer — it covers three real use cases (fitness/interval training, breathwork, and focus/deep work), each with its own audience and its own search vocabulary. That's the central complication this project has to design around: three keyword clusters and three Custom Product Pages instead of one, run on a small starting budget.

3. Scope

In scope	Out of scope (for this project)
Apple Search Ads: Search Results, Search tab, Today tab, Product Page placements	Meta, TikTok, Google, or any non-Apple paid channel
Keyword strategy across all 3 verticals (fitness, breathwork, focus)	Full ASO overhaul (title/subtitle are already reasonably set); only CPP-level metadata is in scope
Custom Product Pages built for ad traffic	Influencer/UGC content production

In scope	Out of scope (for this project)
MMP setup for attribution (installs → trials → subscriptions)	Paywall/pricing redesign (flagged as a dependency, not this project's work)

4. Approach

- **Campaign structure:** four campaign types per the standard Apple Ads model — Brand, Category, Competitor, Discovery — with Category split into three ad groups (fitness, breathwork, focus) instead of one.
- **Keyword strategy:** target mid-popularity, long-tail terms in each vertical (e.g. “hiit timer,” “box breathing app,” “focus timer”) rather than saturated head terms, and use Discovery campaigns purely to mine new terms weekly.
- **Creative:** one Custom Product Page per vertical, each built around Cadence's actual presets (Tabata, Box Breathing, Reading Stamina) and its privacy-first positioning, since that's a real differentiator against bigger incumbents.
- **Sequencing:** don't run all three verticals at full budget from day one — use the first two weeks of Discovery data to find which vertical is cheapest/strongest, then concentrate spend there before expanding.
- **Measurement:** install a mobile measurement partner before spending seriously, so performance can be tracked all the way to trial starts and subscription revenue, not just installs.

5. Timeline

Phase	Key activities	Exit criteria
Weeks 1-2Setup	Install MMP. Link App Store Connect. Launch Brand (“cadence interval timer”) + Discovery only, run broadly across all 3 verticals at \$5-10/day.	Enough Discovery data to identify the strongest-converting vertical
Weeks 3-6Focus	Launch Category campaign (5-10 exact-match keywords) in the winning vertical. Build its matching Custom Product Page. Promote winning Discovery terms weekly.	CPP beats default page conversion rate; IPM trending up
Weeks 7-10Expand	Add Category keywords for the 2nd vertical. Launch an isolated Competitor campaign for the lead vertical with a hard CPA ceiling.	2nd vertical live; Competitor CPA within 1.5x of Category CPA
Weeks 11-13Scale	Bring the 3rd vertical online if budget allows. Reassess CPG against real subscription conversion data. Prepare New Year seasonal push for the fitness vertical.	ROAS ≥ 2.5x on blended spend; all 3 verticals have a documented keyword list

6. Budget

Start at \$5-10/day given the current zero-review stage — this is enough for roughly 5-15 installs a day while data is still being gathered. Scale to \$10-20/day once the winning vertical is identified (weeks 3-6), and to \$15-30/day once a full four-campaign structure is running on that vertical. Hold off on Competitor campaigns (which run 40-60% higher CPA) until past the first budget tier.

7. What Needs to Be in Place

- Apple Ads account set up and linked to App Store Connect, with a valid payment method on file.
- App Store Connect access with the Marketing role, needed to build Custom Product Pages.
- An MMP (AppsFlyer or Adjust) integrated before Category spend begins, so trial-start and subscription data is visible, not just installs.
- A short list of confirmed direct competitors per vertical to bid on later (fitness: Seconds, Tabata Pro; breathwork: Breathwrk, iBreathe; focus: Forest, Be Focused) — not needed until the Competitor phase.

8. Success Metrics

The project's core goal — more people on the App Store page — shows up directly in impressions and taps per keyword, which is why that's tracked from week one rather than waiting for install data. The metrics below round that out with the quality checks needed to confirm the traffic is worth paying for.

Metric	Target (starting point)	Why it matters
Tap-Through Rate (TTR)	Track vs. ~10% category avg	Signals keyword/ad relevance before someone even reaches the page
Conversion Rate (taps → installs)	Beat ~48% Health & Fitness avg	The core measure of whether the App Store page itself converts visitors
Impressions + page views by keyword	Rising week over week per vertical	This is literally “more people on the app page” — the stated goal
CPA / Cost per Goal (CPG)	≤ \$8-10 per trial start	Keeps spend disciplined once traffic is flowing
ROAS	≥ 2.5x blended	Confirms the traffic is turning into paying subscribers, not just visits

9. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Zero reviews	Lower trust/conversion once someone lands on the page; no organic ranking to lean on yet	Lead with strong CPP creative and the privacy-first angle; treat ASA as the primary discovery lever until reviews build up

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
"Cadence" name collision	Other unrelated apps use the same word; bare "cadence" keyword wastes spend	Bid on the full phrase "cadence interval timer" for Brand, not the bare word
Budget spread across 3 verticals	Small starting budget split 3 ways gets no vertical enough volume to read cleanly	Discovery-first phase (weeks 1-2) identifies the strongest vertical before committing Category budget
No MMP / attribution	Can't see past install — no visibility into trial starts or subscription ROAS	Install AppsFlyer or Adjust before any Category spend begins (Week 1 blocker)

10. Immediate Next Steps

- Confirm Apple Ads account + App Store Connect linking is complete.
- Choose and integrate an MMP.
- Launch the Week 1-2 Brand + Discovery campaigns across all 3 verticals at \$5-10/day.
- Check back at the two-week mark to pick the lead vertical and move to Phase 2.

Full tactical detail (keyword tables, CPP copy guidance, bidding rules, and sourced research) lives in the companion documents: the Cadence Apple Search Ads Playbook and the Apple Ads Knowledge Base.